A-A-53688
16 September 1988

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

FORCEPS, PINNING, ENTOMOLOGICAL SPECIMEN

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to Interim Federal Specification NNN-F-001601.

This commercial item description covers curved forceps with blunt points, suitable for use in pinning entomological specimens.

Salient characteristics.

Shall be curved spring forceps with blunt points, suitable for use in pinning entomological specimens.

The forceps shall be made of carbon steel complying with FED-STD-66, AISI No. 1010 or No. 1020. Shall be nickel, or chrome over nickel plated in accordance with Federal Specifications QQ-N-290 and QQ-C-320.

Style and design shall be in accordance with Figure 1. The legs shall be double spot welded. The handles shall have forged, corrugated serrations to permit a firm finger grip. The tip serrations shall be double file-cut or stamped to insure firm grip of entomological specimens and pins.

The areas of greatest reduction in thickness (the tips and spring) shall have Rockwell hardness from B-88 to B-105, and the thicker areas (handles) shall have Rockwell hardness from B-75 to B-80 when tested in accordance with ASTM Designation E18.

There shall be no signs of corrosion on the smooth surfaces of the forceps when subjected to the following test: The forceps shall be scrubbed with soap and water, rinsed thoroughly in distilled water, and dried. After cleaning, the forceps shall be boiled in distilled water, in a glass beaker, for 30 minutes and allowed to remain submerged for an additional 24 hours. a slight corrosion in the tip serrations will not be cause for rejection.

AMSC N/A FSC 6640

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The forceps shall have a guidepin as shown in Figure 1.

Dimensions shall be in accordance with Figure 1.

Workmanship. The forceps shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or impair their serviceability.

Unit. Each (EA). One forceps, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Reference standards and specifications. Where standards and specifications are referenced herein, the issue of that standard or specification in effect on the date of solicitation shall be used to determine compliance with stated requirements.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard 376, and all other requirements of this document are met. If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch-pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable. The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

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Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Inspections and tests. Inspections and tests shall be conducted in accordance with commercial practice to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for inspections and tests. Sampling for inspections and tests shall be conducted in accordance with commercial practice. The unit of product for tests purposes shall be one forceps.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U. S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/ contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers

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and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

6640-00-426-0250

Ordering data. (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - MB

AGENT:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6640-1513

Location: Disk No. 13

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1 DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-53688	FORCEPS, PINNING, ENTOMOLOGICAL SPECIMEN

3a NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b ADDRESS *(Street City State ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a Paragraph Number and Wording

b Recommended Wording

c Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7a NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last First MI)* – Optional	b WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c MAILING ADDRESS *(Street City State ZIP Code)* – Optional	8 DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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